

Butterfly Lovers

Long ago in China, at a time when girls were expected to stay at home and learn household work while the boys went to school, a girl named Zhu **harboured** a desire to study.

Her family was wealthy and Zhu was **pampered**, but her father did not want to go against tradition. When she **pestered** him, he told her that if she got admission into a school, he would not stop her from studying. He was confident that no school would admit a girl.

But Zhu was **resourceful**. She **disguised** herself as a boy and **managed to** get admission into a school in the city of Hangzhou, where her aunt lived.

Every morning she would **put on** her **disguise** and go to school.

There was a boy named Liang in her class. The two were drawn to each other, and **in course of time** became good friends. As the months and the years passed, they became **inseparable companions**, and Zhu realised that she was in love.

She wanted to stay with Liang the rest of her life. She thought of a plan. She told Liang that when they finished school, and he had got a job, he should come to her house and ask her father for her sister's hand.

Liang readily agreed. He too did not want to lose Zhu. If he married her sister, they could continue to meet.

After finishing school, Liang **lost no time** in taking up a job, and when he had saved enough to get married, he **hastened** to Zhu's house.

Zhu saw him coming and was **overjoyed**. It was a year since they had **parted** and she had missed him **terribly**. Unable to **restrain** herself, she **rushed out** shouting, "I'm your friend, as you can see I'm a girl, I cannot live without you!"

Liang was **dazed** by the **revelation**, but soon recovered and caught Zhu in a warm **embrace**. Suddenly everything had **fallen into place**. Now he knew why he had felt such a strong love for Zhu.

Zhu took him to her father who listened attentively to what Liang had to say, but when the young man asked for Zhu's hand, he **shook his head**.



He told Liang that Zhu had already been promised to another man, a wealthy **merchant**. Nothing that Liang said could make Zhu's father change his mind.

Liang left, **shattered**. He felt **frighteningly** alone. The thought that he would never see Zhu again filled him with pain. On the way, he **collapsed** and died.

When Zhu learnt of Liang's death, she lost all desire to continue living. She **pretended** to agree to the marriage arranged for her on the condition that the wedding **procession** passed by Liang's **grave**.

As the wedding procession neared the **cemetery**, the wind began to **howl** and the sky grew dark. Zhu jumped down from her **palanquin** and, rushing to Liang's grave, threw herself on it, **sobbing** uncontrollably.

A **peal** of **thunder** suddenly rent the air. The next moment, a **bolt** of lightning hit the grave, breaking it open. Zhu **leapt into** it.

The storm **subsided** as quickly as it had started. When Zhu's relatives reached the grave and **peered** into it, all they saw at first was an empty **coffin**. Then out flew two butterflies, dancing as if they could not believe they were together.

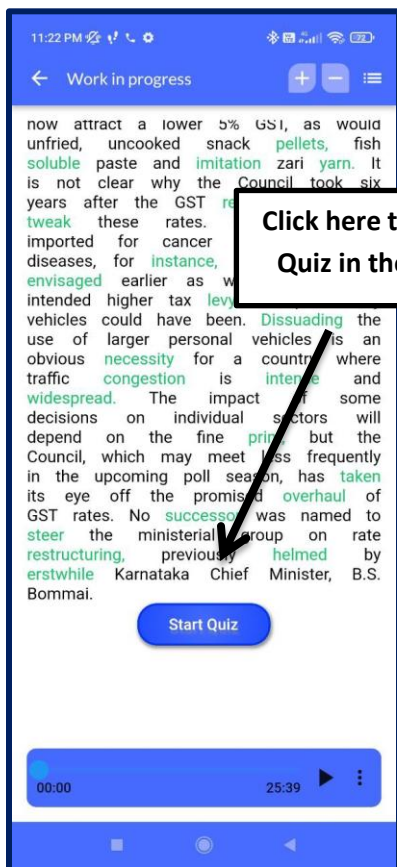
And as the people standing around the grave watched in **fascination** and **bewilderment**, the two lovely butterflies flew **out of sight**.

Vocabulary

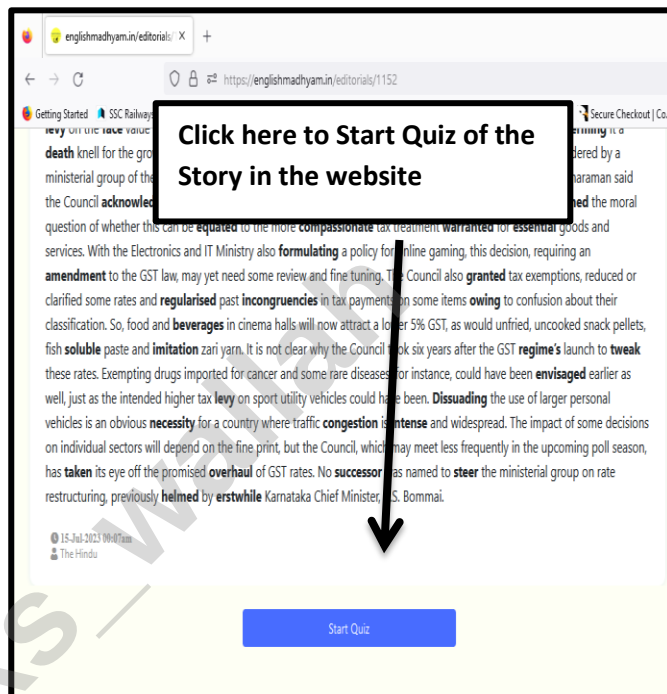
1. **Long ago** (phrase) – once upon a time, in the past, a while back, ages ago, years ago – बहुत पहले
2. **Harbour** (verb) – hold, nurture, entertain, foster, cherish – मन में रखना / पालना
3. **Pamper** (verb) – spoil, indulge, coddle, baby, cosset – लाड़-प्यार करना
4. **Pester** (verb) – annoy, bother, nag, harass, badger – बार-बार तंग करना
5. **Resourceful** (adjective) – clever, inventive, capable, creative, enterprising – चतुर / संसाधनयुक्त
6. **Disguise** (verb) – conceal, mask, hide, camouflage, cover – छिपाना / भेस बदलना
7. **Manage** (to) (verb) – succeed in, be able to, cope, accomplish, carry out – सफल होना
8. **Put on** (phrasal verb) – wear, dress in, don, slip into, get into – पहनना
9. **Disguise** (noun) – costume, camouflage, mask, concealment, cover – भेस / वेशभूषा
10. **In course of time** (phrase) – eventually, over time, gradually, with time, in due time – समय के साथ
11. **Inseparable** (adjective) – close, united, attached, connected, devoted – अविभाज्य / अलग न हो सकने वाला
12. **Companion** (noun) – friend, partner, associate, ally, comrade – साथी
13. **Lose no time** (phrase) – act immediately, hurry, rush, go quickly, not delay – समय न गँवाना
14. **Hasten** (verb) – hurry, rush, speed up, accelerate, dash – जल्दी करना / तेजी लाना
15. **Overjoyed** (adjective) – thrilled, delighted, ecstatic, elated, jubilant – बहुत प्रसन्न
16. **Part** (verb) – separate, leave, split, diverge, go away – बिछड़ना
17. **Terribly** (adverb) – extremely, badly, greatly, intensely, awfully – बहुत ज्यादा
18. **Restrain** (verb) – hold back, control, suppress, curb, check – रोकना / संयम रखना
19. **Rush out** (phrasal verb) – dash out, run out, hurry out, storm out, burst out – दौड़कर बाहर निकलना
20. **Daze** (verb) – stun, confuse, bewilder, shock, stupefy – हक्का-बक्का कर देना
21. **Revelation** (noun) – disclosure, unveiling, discovery, surprise, realization – रहस्योद्घाटन / खुलासा
22. **Embrace** (noun) – hug, hold, cuddle, squeeze, clasp – गले लगना

23. **Fall into place** (phrase) – make sense, become clear, fit together, be understood – स्पष्ट हो जाना
24. **Shook one's head** (phrase) – refuse, deny, disagree, say no – सिर हिलाकर मना करना
25. **Merchant** (noun) – trader, dealer, businessman, seller, vendor – व्यापारी
26. **Shattered** (adjective) – devastated, heartbroken, destroyed, broken, ruined – टूट चुका / बिखरा हुआ
27. **Frighteningly** (adverb) – terrifyingly, alarmingly, horrifically, scarily, disturbingly – डरावने ढंग से
28. **Collapse** (verb) – faint, fall down, break down, crumple, sink – गिर जाना
29. **Pretend** (verb) – act, fake, feign, simulate, make believe – नाटक करना / दिखावा करना
30. **Procession** (noun) – parade, march, caravan, line, sequence – जुलूस
31. **Grave** (noun) – tomb, burial site, sepulcher, resting place – कब्र
32. **Cemetery** (noun) – graveyard, burial ground, churchyard, necropolis – कब्रिस्तान
33. **Howl** (verb) – wail, cry, roar, yell, scream – तेज़ आवाज़ में रोना / चिल्लाना
34. **Palanquin** (noun) – sedan chair, litter, palki (Hindi), carriage, transport – पालकी
35. **Sob** (verb) – cry, weep, wail, bawl, snivel – सिसकना
36. **Peal** (noun) – crash, bang, roll (of thunder), blast, clamor – गड़गड़ाहट / गर्जन
37. **Thunder** (noun) – rumble, roar, boom, crash, clap – गरज
38. **Bolt** (noun) – flash (of lightning), stroke, dart, jolt – बिजली की चमक
39. **Leap into** (phrasal verb) – jump into, dive into, plunge into, bound into – छलांग लगाना
40. **Subside** (verb) – lessen, decrease, abate, fade, dwindle – कम हो जाना / शांत होना
41. **Peer** (verb) – look closely, gaze, stare, scrutinize, glance – झाँक कर देखना
42. **Coffin** (noun) – casket, box, bier, sarcophagus – ताबूत
43. **Fascination** (noun) – attraction, enchantment, interest, charm, allure – आकर्षण
44. **Bewilderment** (noun) – confusion, puzzlement, perplexity, disorientation, daze – उलझन / चकित होना
45. **Out of sight** (phrase) – invisible, gone, vanished, no longer seen, disappeared – आँखों से ओझल

Practice Exercise



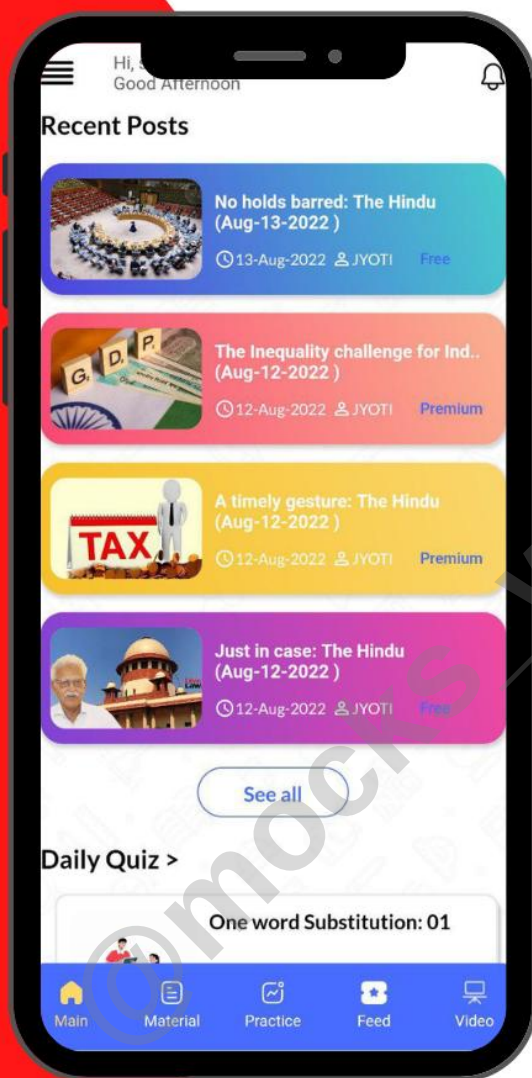
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